

MNCs, including Intel and Airbus, now have their own incubators to help these startups.

**Q Has the Indian government played a significant role in supporting/promoting BIF or your initiatives?**

The startup initiatives by the Indian government are promising. We are a beneficiary of the Startup India Fund of Funds by SIDBI. A similar initiative by the Electronics Development Fund (EDF) is worth mentioning. Startup India initiatives by the government are oriented in the right direction. A number of incubators and accelerators, including the government, academia and MNCs, are already helping the startups and handholding them through the initial stages. Similarly, the different state governments are supporting the startups in their own way. The initiative of giving grants to qualified startups by the government of Karnataka as part of its 'Idea2Poc' and 'Elevate' initiatives is helping the overall startup ecosystem in the state.

Initiatives by the Department of BioTechnology with grant programmes like the BIRAC (Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council) 'BIG Grant' scheme have done extremely well for the early stage healthcare and biotechnology startups in India. Such initiatives in other sectors would be a welcome move. Encouraging the Indian financial institutions and the fund managers of vast family-run enterprises to invest in venture funds and private equity funds would actually increase the pool of risk capital significantly, for later stage funding. This is still extremely mini-scale in India, especially for the type of startups we are focusing on.

**Q What more can be done in the field of funding?**

One big challenge in the Indian startup ecosystem, especially in the B2B space, is the lack of early adopters among Indian customers. An initiative that earmarks a small portion of the technology and solutions budget assigned

to the different states and central government, for qualified startups, could be a welcome initiative.

Efforts are underway for the government to offer preferential access to Indian companies for critical infrastructure, defence and security needs. Similarly, creating an incentive structure for the bigger companies to acquire a small portion of their purchases from Indian startups would create a vibrant customer base. We live today in a volatile, uncertain, complex, and ambiguous (VUCA) world, and existing businesses and business models are being transformed in ways unheard of. To remain competitive, the large technology and solutions buyers could benefit immensely by engaging with the startup ecosystem. To a limited degree, we are starting to see this happen in India, but we need to do a lot more.

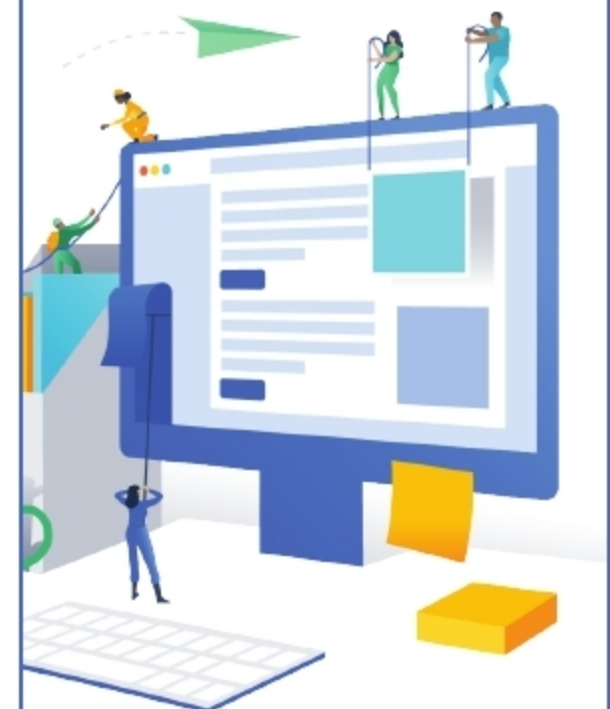
**Q What would you advise the entrepreneurs in India who plan to start their own technology business?**

Entrepreneurship is tough and not for the faint-hearted. Forming a balanced team with both business and technology acumen, understanding and scoping out the problem statement, devising a technology solution that isn't right just for today but also defensible in the long run, getting traction with early lead customers, are some of the general yet crucial recommendations. I would recommend every aspiring entrepreneur to read the 'The Startup Owner's Manual' that highlights the lean startup models and also binge watch the TV show 'Sharktank'.

Every startup is unique. Startups transform industries and business models; hence, by nature they should be disruptive and should not follow a unique proven formula other than the basics. Based on what I have seen in the startup ecosystem so far, I would tell entrepreneurs to conduct better market research and do a competitive landscape analysis. Then look for opportunities to partner, rather than build the entire solution on your own. **END** 

**WANT  
US TO  
DESIGN  
YOUR  
ADS?**

**NOT A PROBLEM!**



It's a free\* service we offer to all our advertisers who want to avail it.

Tell us what you want, and let us do it for you!

Write to: [advtg1@efy.in](mailto:advtg1@efy.in)

\*Can avail after signing contract/advance payment